> this pressure and instead focus on testing. Even if there are more positive cases, let it be. Only then, we will be able to find a solution. If there is a need to increase shifts in labs (so that increased workloads can be better handled without compromising on the quality of sample collection and processing), then I think it should be done. As I said earlier, we have to put emphasis on testing in containment zones. Not a single person should be left without testing in the containment zones. You will see faster results.[19]

He suggested to the chief ministers to adhere to and pay proper attention to the SOPs which the Union Health Ministry had prepared for containment zones after a lot of research and experience. He also advised them to get hospitals in the states to join webinars organized by AIIMS Delhi in order to be fully aware of the National Clinical Management Protocols.

The PM also informed them that while the Centre was making efforts to increase the capacity of vaccine manufacturing to the maximum along with the development of new vaccines, it wasn't easy to increase capacities overnight. Hence, we would need to prioritize their use based on limited availability. He said,

> The nationwide strategy was made only after discussions and consent from the state governments. I request you to focus on vaccinating all those who are above 45 years in the high focus districts on priority by keeping a check on vaccine wastage.[20]

He suggested running a dedicated four-day campaign 'Tika Utsav' to create awareness of the vaccine and try to get as many eligible folks vaccinated as possible, looking at it as a trust-building exercise in the people for the government's vaccination efforts.[21]

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Over the next week, the prime minister held extensive review meetings starting with one on the status of oxygen availability and supplies. In pre-COVID times, ordinarily India produced 9,000 tonnes of liquid oxygen each day, out of which 10–15 per cent went towards medical supplies and the rest was used in industries such as steel making.[22] India's demand of liquid medical oxygen (LMO) pre-COVID was about 700 tonnes per day, which increased to 5,700 MT per day during the first wave in August